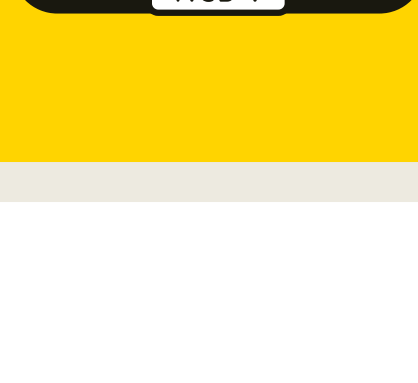


Brand guidelines

Version 1.0 · August 2026
Based on homepage concepts G & H



01 · THE BRAND IDEA

It's handled.

Motor Claims Department exists for the worst hour of someone's week. The person calling has just been hit, isn't sure who pays, and expects an argument. Everything the brand does — every colour, word and button — works to replace that anxiety with one feeling: **someone competent has taken over**.

Confident, not corporate

We sound like a capable friend in the trade, not an insurer. Short sentences. Plain words. No small print energy.

Visible, like hi-vis

Safety yellow is borrowed from the roadside: cones, jackets, recovery trucks. It signals help has arrived.

Warm, not clinical

Rounded type, soft radii and cream surfaces keep the brand human where insurers feel procedural.

02 · WORDMARK

Two lines, one highlight

The wordmark is set in Quicksand Bold, lowercase, on two lines. "department" always carries the yellow chip — the same highlighter gesture used in headlines, making the logo and the typography one system.

motor claims
department

motor claims
department

motor claims
department

DO

- Keep clearspace equal to the cap height of "m" on all sides
- Use the ink-chip version on yellow, the yellow-chip version everywhere else
- Use "MCD" only as a favicon / app-icon shorthand

DON'T

- Set the wordmark on one line or in another typeface
- Drop the chip, outline it, or recolour it outside the palette
- Use title case or all caps — the mark is always lowercase

03 · COLOUR

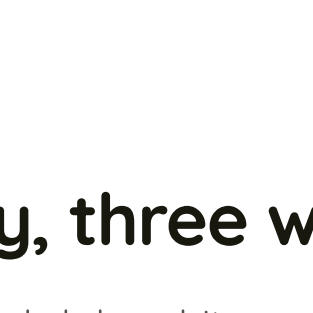
Hi-vis, used sparingly

The palette is deliberately small. Pages are mostly white and cream so that yellow keeps its roadside urgency — roughly **60% white, 25% cream, 10% ink, 5% yellow**. Yellow is a highlighter, never a wallpaper (the hero panel is the one full-bleed exception).



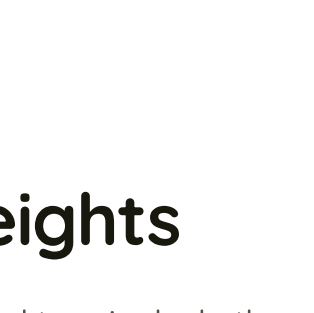
Safety Yellow
#FFD400

Highlights, CTAs, hero



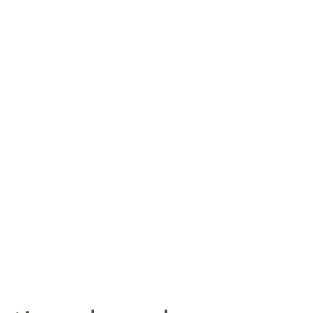
Ink
#19180F

Text, buttons, footer



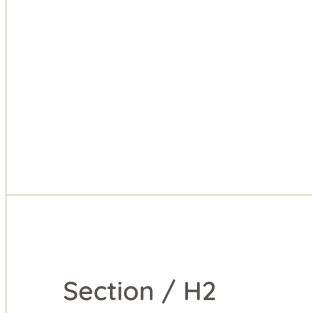
Cream
#F7F5EF

Alternating bands, cards



White
#FFFFFF

Primary surface



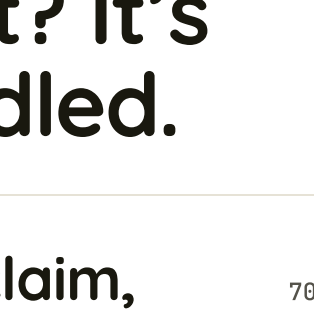
Body Grey #54524A

Paragraph text only



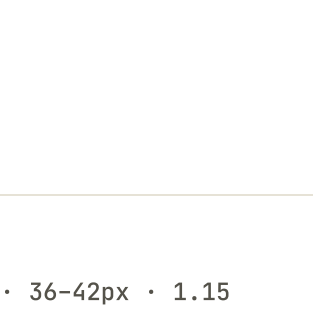
Ochre #B08900

Text links, eye brows



Pale Yellow #FFF6C9

Illustration fills, tints



Hairline #E6E2D6

Borders, dividers

Accessibility rule: body text is never set in yellow, and yellow surfaces only ever carry ink text (contrast 14.9:1). Ochre is reserved for text of 14px and above on white or cream.

04 · TYPOGRAPHY

One family, three weights

Quicksand carries the whole brand. Its rounded terminals do the emotional work — friendly without being childish — so no display face is needed. JetBrains Mono appears only in technical contexts (reference numbers, labels in documents).

Display / H1

Not your
fault? It's
handled.

700 · 56–64px · 1.05

Section / H2

Your claim,
without the
chaos

700 · 36–42px · 1.15

Card title / H3

Same-day
replacement car

700 · 20–24px · 1.3

Body

A single specialist owns
your claim from first call to
fixed car.

500 · 15–17px · 1.65

Button / UI

Start your claim

600–700 · 15–16px

The highlighter rule

We know a shortcut

A half-height yellow underlay marks the emotional payoff of a headline — the last 2–4 words, once per section, never twice on one screen. On dark surfaces use the solid chip instead.

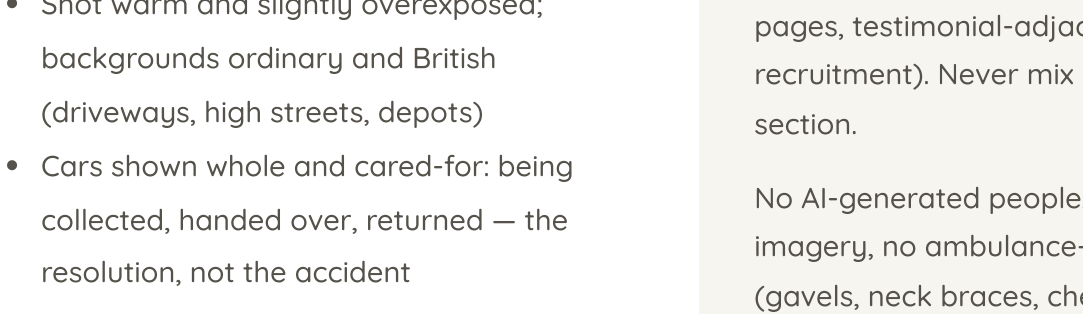
Setting rules

- Sentence case everywhere; never all caps, never italics
- Headlines ask-and-answer: a worry, then the fix
- Tracking -0.015 to -0.025em on sizes above 30px
- Body copy maxes at ~65 characters per line

05 · ICONOGRAPHY

Round-capped line icons

Icons are drawn on a 24px grid with a **1.6–1.8px stroke, round caps and round joins**, echoing Quicksand's terminals. They are always ink — never yellow — and sit inside a yellow circular chip when used as a feature marker.



DO

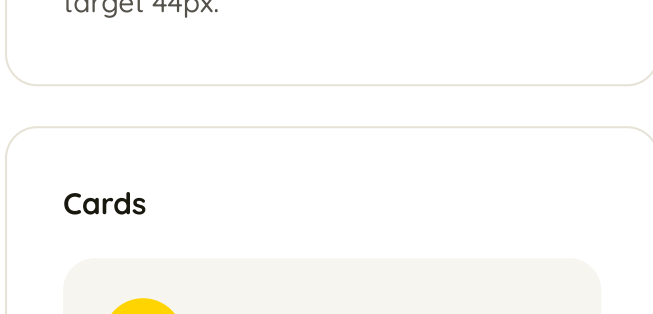
- Keep strokes optically even; scale in whole steps (20 / 24 / 28 / 34px)
- Use the ticked circle (yellow fill) for positives, outlined cross for negatives
- Pair every icon with a text label in UI

DON'T

- Use filled, two-tone or emoji-style icons
- Recolour icons yellow, grey or ochre
- Use icons decoratively where they carry no meaning

06 · ILLUSTRATION & IMAGERY

Bold outlines, honest photos



Illustration

- 5px ink outlines** at hero scale, generous rounded corners
- Fills limited to ink, cream, pale yellow and white
- Motion lines and simple shadows add energy, never gradients
- Subjects are vehicles and journeys — never crash damage or injury
- Used on yellow or cream panels, one per screen

Photography

- Real staff and real customers in daylight — candid, relieved, mid-conversation; never stock-photo handshakes
- Shot warm and slightly overexposed; backgrounds ordinary and British (driveways, high streets, depots)
- Cars shown whole and cared-for: being collected, handed over, returned — the resolution, not the accident
- Frame photos inside the 16–24px radius card; a yellow chip caption may overlap the corner

When to use which

Illustration explains the service (heroes, empty states, how-it-works). **Photography** proves the people (team pages, testimonial-adjacent sections, recruitment). Never mix both in a single section.

No AI-generated people, no wreckage imagery, no ambulance-chaser clichés (gavels, neck braces, cheques).

07 · UI COMPONENTS

Soft geometry, firm hierarchy

Buttons

Start your claim

Call 0800 048 0048

Start your claim

Full pills, 15–16px bold. Ink primary on light, yellow primary on ink. One primary button per view; the phone number is always the secondary. Minimum touch target 44px.

Chips & tags

Non-fault accidents

Motorbike claims

Taxi & fleet

Outlined pills for browsable categories; the inverted pill marks the selected state.

Cards



No-claims protected

You never claim on your own policy.

16–24px radius, flat cream or white fills, hairline or 1.5px ink borders. Shadows only on floating elements (nav, product buttons on yellow).

Accordion / FAQ rows

What's the catch? —

Do I speak to my insurer? +

Hairline dividers, plus/minus glyphs, first item open by default so the page never hides its best answer.

08 · UX PRINCIPLES

Designed for the worst hour of the week

1

The phone is the product

0800 048 0048 appears in the nav, hero and footer of every page, always as a live tel: link. On mobile it becomes a sticky call bar. A visitor should never scroll to find it.

2

One decision per screen

Each section carries exactly one primary action — start a claim or call. Everything else (FAQ links, claim types) is quiet text. No competing banners, popups or newsletter asks.

3

Answer the fear before the form

The three worries — will it cost me, will I lose my bonus, will I be without a car — are answered above the fold in plain words. Objection-first FAQ ordering ("What's the catch?" comes first, opened).

4

Show the taking-over

The new-way / old-way comparison, the named handler, and the claim tracker all dramatise the same promise: hand it to us and watch it move. Every step a user completes is confirmed instantly and visibly.

5

Calm under stress

Generous whitespace, one thought per line, no countdowns or urgency tricks. Motion is minimal: 150–200ms ease-out on hovers and accordions, nothing that moves uninvited.

6

Accessible by default

Ink-on-white and ink-on-yellow both exceed WCAG AAA. Touch targets ≥44px, focus rings in ink (2px, 2px offset), all icons labelled, and the whole journey completable by phone for anyone who prefers a human.

09 · VOICE

Short. Sure. On your side.

The signature construction is a worry answered in two beats: **"Fast. It's handled."** Headlines name the reader's situation before our service. We say "you" twice as often as "we".

WE SAY

- "Not your fault? It's handled."
- "Skip the excess. Not a penny."
- "One call sorts the lot."

NOT

- "We provide comprehensive accident management solutions"
- "Subject to eligibility criteria" (in headline copy)
- "Don't delay — claim today!" (urgency tricks)

